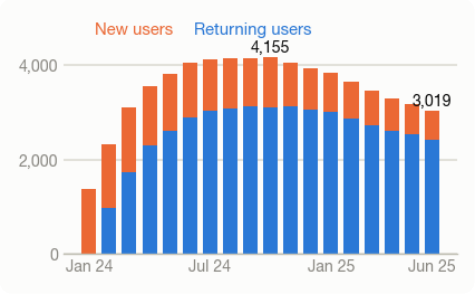
BNPL is shrinking because fewer new users arrive, not because users leave faster

Users leave at about the same pace as before, 1 in 4 a month; new users fell 56% since early 2024. Retention alone would need churn below 20% for everyone, the level of our most frequent buyers, so bringing new users back is the bigger lever.

Active users, Jun 2025	New users, Jun 2025	Active users lost each month	Still active after 12 months	Payment volume, Jun 2025
3,019	**596**	**1 in 4**	**4%**	**1.76B VND**
–27% from Jul–Oct 2024 (~4,150)	–56% from early 2024 (~1,370 a month)	23.5–26.3% every month since Feb 2024	none who stopped came back in this data	–23% from the Nov 2024 peak

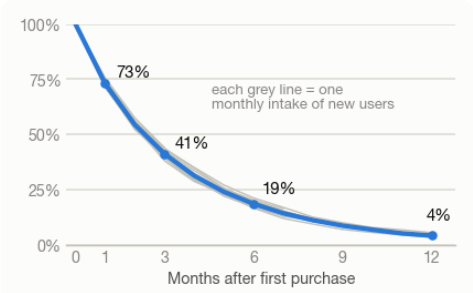
1 · WHAT IS HAPPENING

Active users fell because new users fell



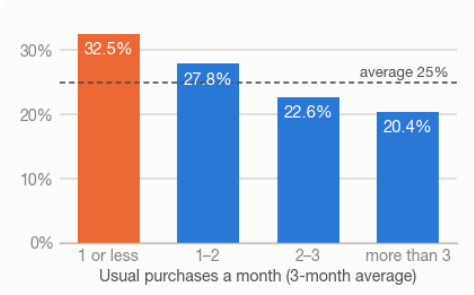
New users a month went from ~1,370 in early 2024 to 596 in Jun 2025, about 5% fewer every month. From May to Jun 2025 we lost ~750 active users and gained ~600, so the base shrinks.

Every intake of new users loses about 1 in 4 a month



73% are still active after 1 month, 4% after 12. Every monthly intake since Jan 2024 follows a very similar curve, and nobody who stopped came back.

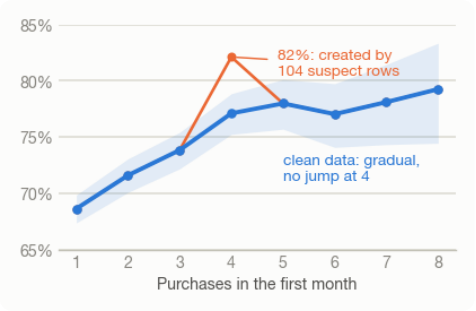
Users who rarely buy leave most



Share who stop the next month, by usual purchases a month: 32.5% for one or less, about 20% above three. Limit, purchase size and category add nothing once frequency is known. 6 in 10 of last month's users still silent on the 15th buy nothing more that month.

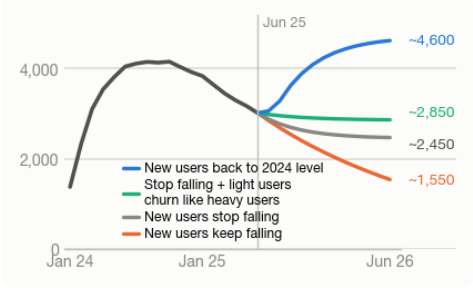
2 · WHAT IT MEANS

There is no magic "4 purchases in the first month"



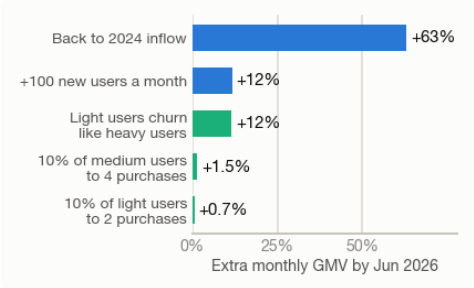
Share active in month 2, by purchases in month 1. It rises gradually; the jump at 4 came from 104 suspect rows. A practical goal is a second purchase: 31% of new users stop at one.

New users are the biggest lever



Active users to Jun 2026 under four assumptions. If light users churned like heavy users, the line only flattens; 2024-level inflow turns it up.

In payment volume, new users matter most



100 extra new users a month add as much as light users churning like heavy users (+12% each). Moving 10% of medium users to 4 purchases adds 1.5%.

3 · WHAT WE SHOULD DO NEXT

#	Action	Owner	Why it matters
1	**Find where new users dropped and fix it**: reach, approval or first use? ~730 a month holds the Jun 2025 base.	Growth + Risk	Biggest lever: ~2,150 more active users in a year at the 2024 level vs flat inflow.
2	**Remind users who haven't used BNPL by mid-month**, by day 10 for frequent users (test on eligible users first).	CRM	If it saves 1 in 10 would-be leavers: ~270 more active users in a year. Answer in 1–3 months.
3	**Help new users make a second purchase, then reward occasional users for using BNPL more often** (test first; slower to read).	Product + CRM	Occasional users leave most. ~390 active users in a year if they churned like heavy users.
4	**Give Finance what a new user brings**: ~1.85M VND of payments in their first 7 months.	Finance + Growth	Finance sets a cost-per-user limit after revenue share, funding and credit losses.
5	**Ask Risk why people who stop never come back** (account lock?) before any win-back offer.	Risk + CRM	About 15,000 former users; the response is unknown.

Also worth knowing

- **Heavy users carry the business:** 38% of active users, 65% of payment volume.
- **Frequent users can be reached earlier:** those who usually buy 5+ times a month and are silent on day 10 are already 60% lost; they made 29% of the last-month payments of users who leave.
- **The credit fields can't guide credit decisions:** limits look randomly assigned and balances follow a mechanical rule. Get the real repayment data first.
- **The data needs checking:** it covers 18 months, not 6; 104 suspect rows created the "4 purchases" myth; several fields look simulated. Confirm the new-user drop against official numbers.

Don't set limits or risk rules from this file, and don't set a "4 purchases in the first month" target.

Decision needed: approve a two-week review of where new users dropped, and the mid-month reminder test (answer in 1–3 months) once eligibility and consent are confirmed.

Active user = at least one BNPL purchase that month; new user = first purchase seen in the data. Occasional / medium / heavy = 1 / 2–3 / 4+ purchases a month. Lines to Jun 2026 are scenarios from Jun 2025, not forecasts; sizes are assumptions to test, before incentive cost and credit losses. GMV is not revenue. 104 suspect rows excluded. Full analysis: 2_Full_Report.pdf.